

NESS Heritage

User Guide — Anne Frank House, Secret Annex

Immersive Augmented Reality Tour

Contents

1. Welcome & Introduction
2. Before You Begin (Requirements & Registration)
3. Starting the Tour
4. The AR Interface (HUD Overview)
5. Navigation: The Pink Path
6. Scannable Points of Interest
7. Proximity Detector & Vibration
8. Audio Narration
9. Language Selection
10. The House Map (2D & 3D)
11. Historical Guide Chat
12. AI Storyteller (Diary Narrator)
13. Expert AI Historian
14. Paying with MetaMask
15. Diary Excerpt Overlay
16. Diary Timeline
17. Personal Journal
18. Capture & Share
19. Downloading This Guide
20. Accessibility
21. Troubleshooting
22. Tips for the Best Experience
23. About the Anne Frank House
24. Glossary

1. Welcome & Introduction

Welcome to NESS Heritage, an immersive augmented reality experience that invites you to explore the Anne Frank House and the Secret Annex in Amsterdam. Through a glowing pink path and dozens of scannable points of interest, you will move room by room through the building at 263 Prinsengracht where eight people hid from Nazi persecution for more than two years.

As you travel, each scannable point reveals a vivid, factual explanation generated for that exact spot, accompanied by spoken narration in your chosen language. A historical guide is available to answer your questions in real time, an AI Storyteller shares intimate stories tied to each room, and a handwritten diary excerpt overlay brings Anne's voice close to you.

This guide explains every feature of the experience in detail so that visitors of any technical level can make

the most of their visit.

2. Before You Begin (Requirements & Registration)

Account registration (required)

To use NESS Heritage you must create an account with your email address. The first time you open the experience you will be asked to register or log in before the tour begins.

- Register with your email address and a password.
- A one-time verification code is sent to your email; enter it to confirm your account.
- You can also sign in with Google if you prefer.
- If you already have an account, simply log in with your email and password.
- Forgot your password? Use the 'Forgot password' link on the login screen to reset it by email.

Supported devices

- A modern smartphone, tablet, or computer with a web browser (Chrome, Safari, Edge, or Firefox).
- For the best experience, use a mobile device so the interface fills the screen like a real AR viewer.

Recommended settings

- Turn your device's sound on, or connect headphones, to hear the spoken narration.
- Enable vibration on your phone so the proximity detector can give you a gentle pulse near scannable points.
- Allow the page to use sound — most browsers require a tap before audio can play.
- Use a stable internet connection; explanations are generated live for each scan.

For premium features (optional)

- The AI Storyteller and the Expert AI Historian are paid features. To use them you need a MetaMask-enabled browser (the MetaMask extension on desktop, or the MetaMask app on mobile) and enough ETH in your wallet to cover the payment and network gas fees. See section 14.

3. Starting the Tour

After you register or log in, you will see the NESS Heritage welcome screen. Press the glowing 'Begin AR Tour' button to enter the first room. From this moment the interface switches to the AR view, and the pink guided path appears at the bottom of the screen.

You can leave and return at any time. Your place in the sequence is not saved between sessions, but you can jump to any room instantly using the House Map (see section 10).

4. The AR Interface (HUD Overview)

The heads-up display (HUD) surrounds the scene with controls that stay fixed to the edges of the screen. Reading clockwise from the top:

- Top centre — the status bar shows 'NESS HERITAGE · AR MODE' and your progress, for example 03/14, indicating the current room out of the total.
- Top left buttons — open the House Map (map icon), the Historical Guide (compass), the AI Storyteller (book, amber), your personal Journal (pen), and the Expert AI Historian (crown, gold).
- Top right buttons — mute or unmute narration (speaker), choose your language (globe), open the Diary Timeline (history), download this user guide (download), and capture a photo to share (camera).

- Centre — the room scene with glowing scannable markers.
 - Lower centre — a short narrative line describing the current room, with the hint 'Tap a glowing marker to scan'.
 - Bottom controls — previous-room arrow, the pink path minimap, and the 'Follow' button to advance.
- Faint corner brackets frame the view, and a subtle scan reticle appears while a point is being scanned.

5. Navigation: The Pink Path

A pink fluorescent line guides you through the building in the order the tour is designed. At the bottom of the screen you will find the Pink Path minimap, which shows every room as a node along the route. The node for your current room is highlighted.

- Tap 'Follow' (bottom right) to move to the next room.
- Tap the left arrow (bottom left) to go back to the previous room.
- Tap any node on the Pink Path minimap to jump directly to that room.
- When you reach the final room, the 'Follow' button becomes 'Restart', returning you to the first room.

For a complete overhead view of all rooms and their layout, use the House Map described in section 10.

6. Scannable Points of Interest

Each room contains glowing markers — the scannable points of interest (POIs). Each marker represents a real object or feature of the Annex: the movable bookcase, the radio, Anne's diary, the chestnut tree, and many more across all fourteen rooms.

How to scan

- Tap a glowing marker to scan it.
- A scan reticle appears briefly while the explanation is generated.
- A holographic panel rises from the lower part of the screen showing the title and the explanation.
- The explanation is also read aloud automatically (see section 8).
- Tap the close button (×) on the panel, or tap the dimmed area behind it, to dismiss it and continue exploring.

There are more than fifty scannable points across the tour. You do not need to scan them all — explore the ones that interest you most.

7. Proximity Detector & Vibration

As you move your finger or pointer across a room scene, NESS Heritage quietly measures how close you are to each scannable point. When you come within range of a marker, the device gives a gentle vibration (on supported phones) and a small hint appears: 'Near: [point name] — tap to scan'.

How it works

- Move your finger across the scene (on touch devices) or move your mouse (on desktop).
- When you approach a glowing marker, you will feel a short pulse and see the nearby hint.
- The hint helps you discover points of interest you might otherwise miss.
- Vibration requires a supporting device and browser; on desktop, you will still see the on-screen hint.

The proximity hint disappears as soon as you move away from the marker or open a scan panel.

8. Audio Narration

Every scan is accompanied by spoken narration using your device's built-in speech synthesis. The narration reads the explanation aloud in your selected language at a natural pace.

- Use the speaker icon (top right) to mute or unmute all narration.
- Narration stops automatically when you close a scan panel or change rooms.
- If you do not hear audio, make sure your device is not muted and that you have tapped the screen at least once (browsers block sound until you interact).

Voice quality depends on the voices installed on your device; some languages may sound more natural than others.

9. Language Selection

NESS Heritage supports thirteen languages for explanations and narration. Tap the language button (top right, showing a two-letter code such as EN) to open the language menu.

- Search or scroll the list to find your language.
- Tap a language to select it; the menu closes and the code updates.
- All subsequent scans and narration will use the chosen language.
- Languages written right-to-left, such as Arabic and Hebrew, are displayed with correct RTL direction.

If a language is not listed, the experience defaults to English (United States).

10. The House Map (2D & 3D)

Tap the map icon (top left) to open the House Map, a full-screen overlay showing the layout of the entire building. You can switch between two views:

2D Floor Plan

- An SVG floor plan showing rooms arranged by floor, with the pink navigation path connecting them.
- Tap any room to jump there instantly.

3D Model

- An interactive three-dimensional model of the house you can rotate and zoom.
- Drag to orbit, scroll or pinch to zoom, and tap a room marker to select and travel to it.

Use the toggle at the top of the map to switch between 2D and 3D. Tap the close button to return to the AR view at your chosen room.

11. Historical Guide Chat

Tap the compass icon (top left) to open a conversation with the Historical Guide, a free AI assistant knowledgeable about the Frank and van Daan families, the helpers, the building, the diary, and life in hiding.

Using the guide

- Type your question in the box at the bottom and press send.
- Try the suggested quick-reply buttons for common questions.
- Responses are formatted with headings and lists for easy reading.
- The guide keeps the tone respectful and factual, and will not invent diary quotes or history.

While the guide is open, tap the scroll-text icon in its header to reveal a handwritten diary excerpt for the room you are currently in (see section 15).

12. AI Storyteller (Diary Narrator)

Tap the book icon (top left, amber) to open the AI Storyteller, an AI narrator that shares intimate, room-specific reflections grounded in documented diary entries and accounts.

The AI Storyteller is a premium feature. The first time you open it (and whenever your purchased time has run out) a paywall appears instead of the chat.

Using the Storyteller

- Choose how much time you want to buy (see section 14), then pay with MetaMask.
- Once your time is active, the storyteller is seeded with your current room and narrates a personal story connected to where you are standing.
- It speaks in a literary, respectful voice and will not fabricate diary text.
- Ask follow-up questions to hear more stories from the same room.
- A live countdown of your remaining time is shown in the header.
- Close the storyteller at any time with the × button; your remaining time is preserved.

The AI Storyteller is best experienced with sound on, in a quiet moment.

13. Expert AI Historian

Tap the crown icon (top left, gold) to open the Expert AI Historian, a premium scholarly AI guide for deep questions on Anne Frank, the Secret Annex, the Holocaust, and World War II history.

Using the Historian

- Like the Storyteller, the Expert Historian is a paid feature. Choose your time and pay with MetaMask (see section 14).
- Once active, ask precise questions; the historian answers with dates, nuance, and historical rigor.
- Try the suggested questions, or type your own.
- A live countdown of your remaining time is shown in the header.
- Close at any time with the × button; your remaining time is preserved.

The Expert Historian is ideal when a scan or the free Historical Guide leaves you wanting a deeper, more detailed answer.

14. Paying with MetaMask

Both the AI Storyteller and the Expert AI Historian are paid features. Pricing is simple: \$1 (USD) for every 30 minutes of access. You can choose any duration from 30 minutes up to 10 hours, in 30-minute increments. Each feature keeps its own separate balance of time.

How to pay

- Open the feature you want (Storyteller or Expert Historian). If you have no active time, the paywall appears.
- Choose your duration from the dropdown; the total price updates automatically (for example, 1 hour = \$4, 5 hours = \$20).
- Tap 'Pay with MetaMask'. Your MetaMask wallet opens; confirm the Ethereum transfer.

- The ETH amount is calculated from the live ETH/USD price at the moment of payment, so the dollar value you pay stays correct as the market moves.
- The transfer is sent to the project's Ethereum wallet. Once the transaction is confirmed on-chain, your access time is activated and stored on your device.
- A link to your transaction on Etherscan is shown after a successful payment.

Good to know

- You can buy more time at any moment. New time is added to any remaining balance, so nothing is lost.
- Time is stored per feature and per device. Closing the panel or leaving the tour does not pause the clock, but any remaining minutes stay available the next time you open that feature.
- Requirements: a MetaMask-enabled browser (the MetaMask extension on desktop, or the MetaMask in-app browser on mobile), and enough ETH in your wallet to cover the payment and gas fees.
- If MetaMask is not detected, install it from metamask.io and refresh the page.
- If the ETH price cannot be fetched, the payment is cancelled — simply try again.

15. Diary Excerpt Overlay

From within the Historical Guide chat, tap the scroll-text icon to open a handwritten-style diary excerpt for the current room. The excerpt appears as a tilted, ruled-paper page with Anne's words in a handwriting font.

- If a room has more than one excerpt, use the arrows below the page to turn between them.
- Tap the × or the area around the page to close it.
- The excerpt updates automatically as you move between rooms.

Excerpts are evocative paraphrases grounded in documented diary themes, presented in Anne's voice for intimacy.

16. Diary Timeline

Tap the history icon (top right) to open the Diary Timeline, a vertical timeline of dated diary moments tied to your current room.

- Each entry shows a date, a title, and an expandable excerpt.
- Tap an entry to expand or collapse its text.
- Entries update as you move between rooms, so the timeline always reflects where you are.

The timeline is a quick way to place the room within the chronology of the hiding period, from the move in July 1942 to the arrest in August 1944.

17. Personal Journal

Tap the pen icon (top left, amber) to open your personal journal for the current room. Here you can write and save your own reflections as you move through the Annex.

- Write a note in the composition area and save it; it is stored privately to your account.
- Your saved entries for the current room appear in a list, where you can edit or delete them.
- Tap 'View all' to open the full Journal reflection page, which gathers every note you have written across all rooms.

The journal is a quiet way to process the experience and keep a personal record of your visit.

18. Capture & Share

Tap the camera icon (top right) to capture a photo of the current AR view and share it.

- A short flash confirms the capture, then a share panel opens with a preview of your photo.
- Tap 'Save photo' to download the image to your device.
- Tap 'Share' to open your device's share sheet and send the photo directly to any app.
- Quick links let you post to X (Twitter), Facebook, or WhatsApp, or copy a link to the experience.

Sharing is a great way to invite others to explore the Annex with you.

19. Downloading This Guide

You can download this user guide as a PDF at any time.

- On the welcome screen, press 'Download User Guide' below the 'Begin AR Tour' button.
- During the tour, tap the download icon in the top-right HUD.
- The PDF is generated on your device and saved to your downloads folder.

Keep it for reference, or print it for visitors who prefer a paper guide.

20. Accessibility

- All explanations are shown as text in the scan panel, so the experience is usable without sound.
- Narration supports screen-reader users who prefer spoken text.
- Language selection includes right-to-left scripts with correct directionality.
- The House Map offers both a 2D plan and a 3D model to suit different ways of navigating.
- Vibration cues provide a non-visual signal when near a scannable point.

If you have specific access needs, contact the venue staff for assistance before beginning the tour.

21. Troubleshooting

Cannot start the tour / asked to log in

- You must register with your email and verify it before the tour opens. Complete registration or log in.

No sound during narration

- Tap anywhere on the screen first — browsers block audio until you interact.
- Check that the speaker icon in the HUD is not muted.
- Check your device volume and that headphones are connected properly.

No vibration near markers

- Vibration only works on supporting mobile devices and browsers.
- Ensure vibration is enabled in your device settings.
- On desktop, you will still see the on-screen proximity hint.

Scan panel does not appear

- Check your internet connection; explanations are generated live.
- Tap the marker again, or move to another marker.

MetaMask payment fails

- Make sure MetaMask is installed and enabled, then refresh the page.

- Ensure your wallet has enough ETH for the payment plus gas fees.
- If the ETH price could not be fetched, retry — the price feed is sometimes briefly unavailable.
- If a transaction seems stuck, check its status on Etherscan using the link provided after payment.

Premium feature shows the paywall again

- Your purchased time has expired. Buy more time to continue; new time is added to any remaining balance.

3D map does not load

- Use the 2D floor plan toggle as a fallback.
- Close other heavy apps or tabs to free memory.

22. Tips for the Best Experience

- Use headphones in a quiet space to feel immersed.
- Follow the pink path on your first visit to understand the building's flow.
- Return with the House Map to revisit favourite rooms.
- Try the free Historical Guide with specific questions — it can explain the helpers, the diary's publication, and daily life in hiding.
- Open the AI Storyteller and Diary Excerpt in each room for a personal perspective (Storyteller requires a small payment).
- For deeper questions, unlock the Expert AI Historian and ask about the wider history of the Holocaust and World War II.
- Write a journal entry in rooms that move you, and review them later on the Journal reflection page.
- Capture and share a photo of a moment you want to remember.
- Scan every marker in a room that interests you; many rooms hold several stories.
- Switch languages to share the tour with companions in their own tongue.

23. About the Anne Frank House

From 6 July 1942 to 4 August 1944, eight people hid in the Secret Annex at 263 Prinsengracht, Amsterdam: Otto and Edith Frank, their daughters Margot and Anne, Hermann and Auguste van Daan, their son Peter, and dentist Fritz Pfeffer. They were aided by four trusted employees of Otto's business — Miep Gies, Bep Voskuijl, Victor Kugler, and Johannes Kleiman.

During hiding, Anne Frank kept a diary she addressed to 'Kitty'. After the war, Otto Frank — the only Annex resident to survive — arranged its publication as 'The Diary of a Young Girl', one of the most widely read books in the world.

NESS Heritage is an educational experience dedicated to remembrance. It aims to bring visitors closer to the human reality behind the history, with respect for the people who lived it.

24. Glossary

- Annex / Secret Annex — the hidden rooms behind the movable bookcase at 263 Prinsengracht.
- POI — Point of Interest; a scannable marker in a room.
- HUD — Heads-Up Display; the fixed controls around the AR view.
- Helpers — the trusted staff who concealed and supplied the Annex residents.

- Opekta — Otto Frank's business, which sold pectin and spices, providing the cover for the hiding place.
- Kitty — the imaginary friend to whom Anne addressed her diary.
- Call-up notice — a summons to report for forced labour; Margot's notice in July 1942 triggered the family's move into hiding.
- MetaMask — a cryptocurrency wallet used to pay for the premium AI Storyteller and Expert AI Historian features.
- ETH — Ether, the cryptocurrency used for MetaMask payments on the Ethereum network.
- Gas fee — a small network fee paid to process an Ethereum transaction, in addition to the payment amount.